



RESIDENTIAL CONNECTION EVENTS

Presented by Tamarah Humphreys and Tess Munshower
Wednesday, August 20th, 2025
10:15-11:15 a.m.

Overview

- The purpose of residential connection events
 - Reflection about connection
 - Introduction of this strategy
- Event Planning 101
- Recruitment/Marketing
- Departmental Expectations/Forms
- Residence Life Teams & Initiatives
- Why This Matters



Connection

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How would you define Connection in relation to community?

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What events or experiences contributed to your sense of community at St. Thomas?

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Who helped you feel comfortable or connected on campus?

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How do events play a part in building community?

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How can RAs help residents make connections?

Connecting Through Events

- **Connection is one of our learning outcomes of the Tommie Advantage**
- **Residential Connection Events are a strategy that:**
 - **Provide opportunities for meaningful interactions**
 - **Make for a shared experience between community members**
 - **Hosts memorable moments throughout the year**
 - **Provides spaces for conversation, laughter, skill-building, etc.**
 - **Create new friendships/lasting connections**



EVENT PLANNING 101

Setting you up for success with your events

Know Your Audience

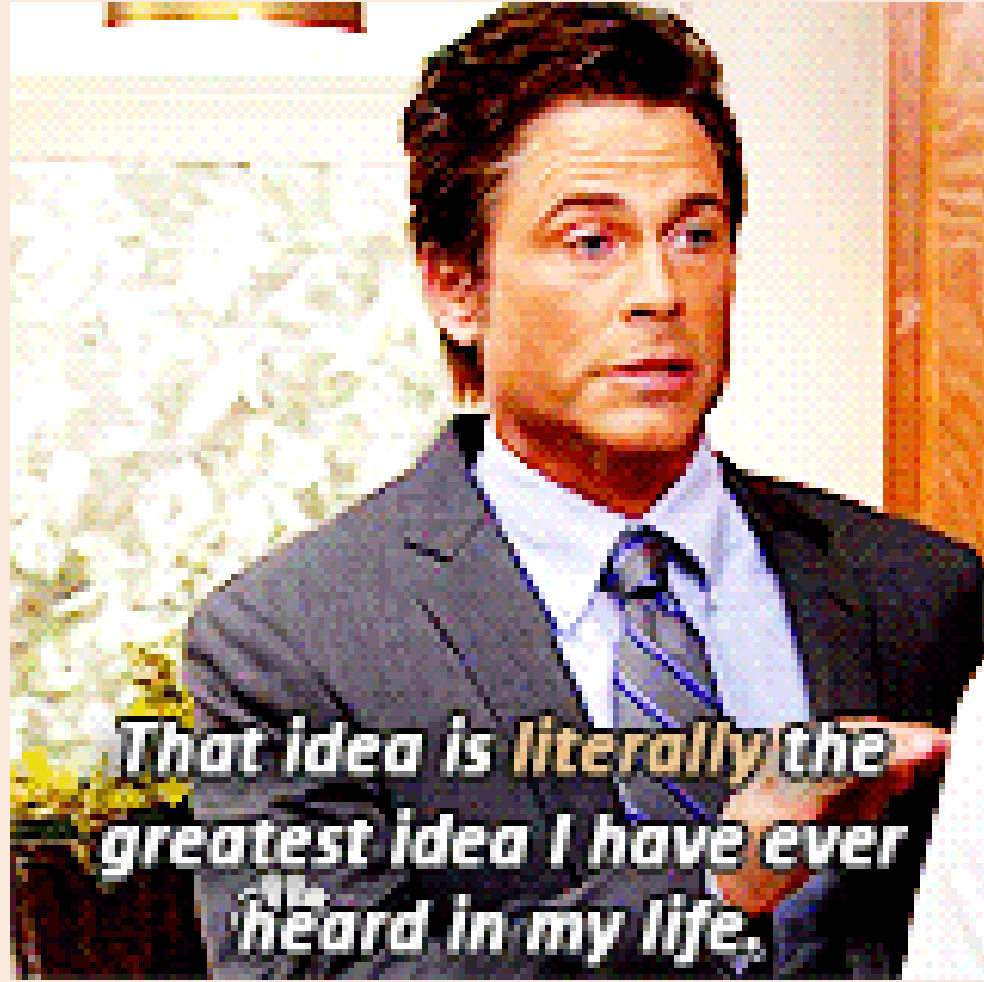
- Be intentional & thoughtful with your events
- Consider the needs and dynamics of your community
 - Be mindful of academic busy times and major scheduling conflicts
 - Be considerate of timing & make attendance an easy yes
 - Ask yourself if the event idea is desirable for your residents
 - Make sure the event is accessible and incorporates universal design
- Change it up
 - No one wants to see the same event over and over...😊
- **ASK YOUR RESIDENTS FOR THEIR INPUT!**



Recruitment & Marketing

- * Personal Invitation
- * Have residents hype it up
- * Flyers & Large Signs
- * Door knocking and hallway chats
- * GroupMe/Email/Calendar Invite



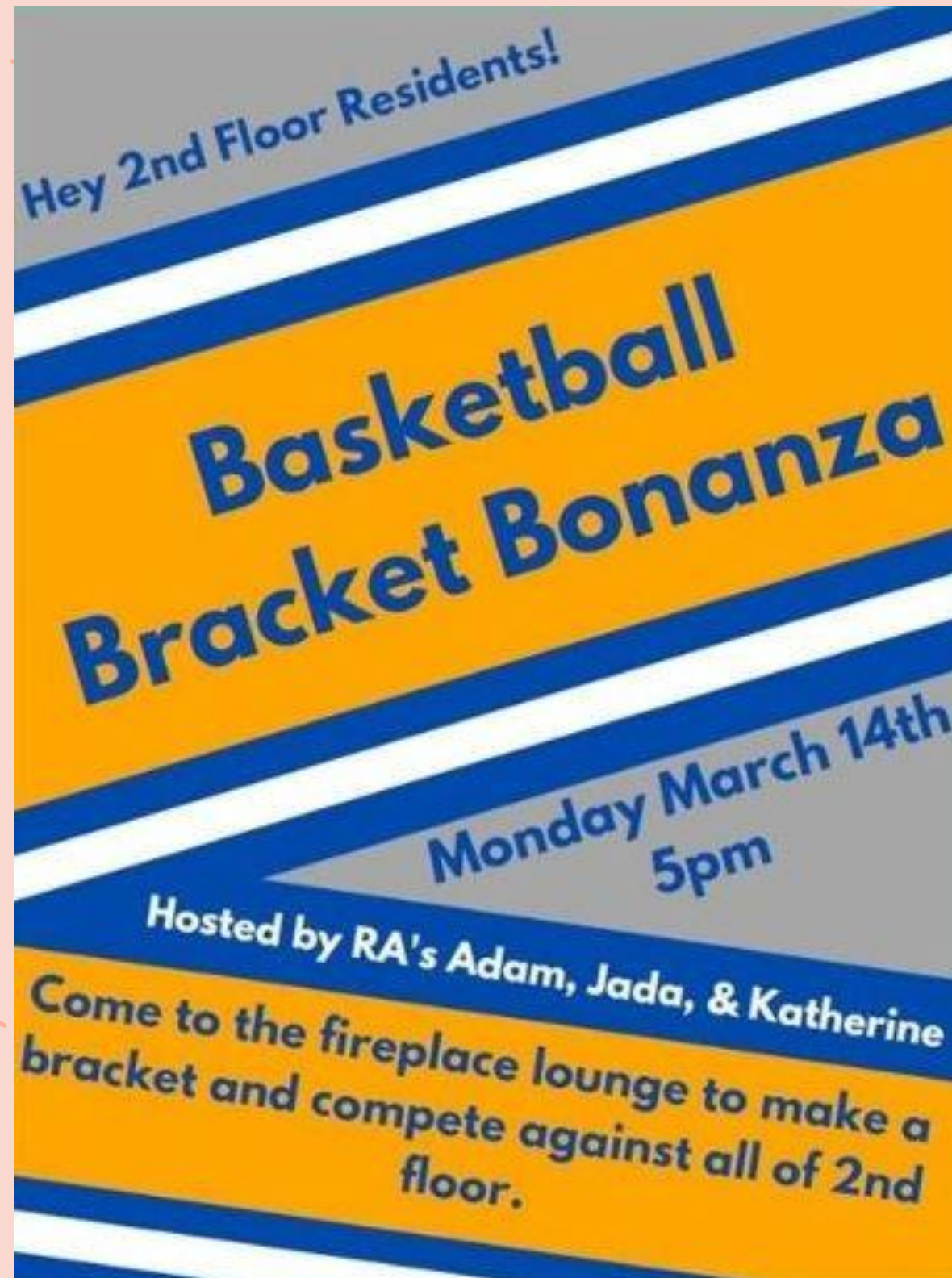


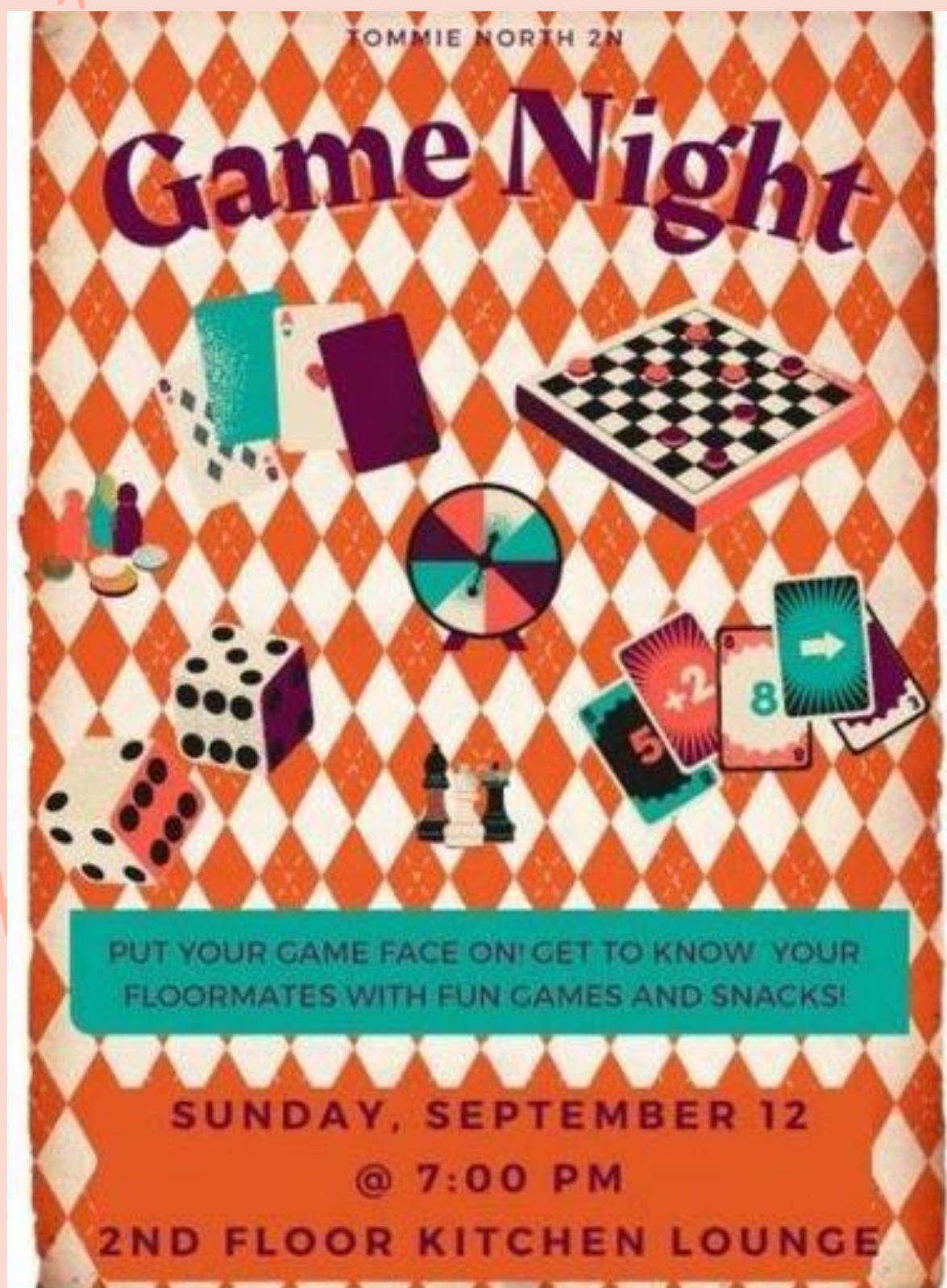
Advertising 101

Pro Tips

- a **Advertise Three Different Ways**
- b **Provide Advance Notice**
- c **Five Ws** (who, what, where, when, why)
- d **Review twice, print once**

Important to note: An accessibility statement needs to be on every flyer and on TommieLink (outlined in your event planning worksheet and in Canvas)



A poster for 'Brady Builds' with a white background and colorful LEGO block borders at the top left and bottom right. It features two line drawings of LEGO minifigures. The main title 'Brady Builds' is in large, bold letters. Below it, the date 'Friday, February 14th' and the location 'Location: Brady Desk and seating area' are listed. The time 'Time: 5:30-7pm' is also provided. A large red heart made of LEGO bricks is on the left. To the right, a text box says: 'Join us for building valentines, flowers, and enjoy an opportunity to get creative! Anything you build at the event you can take home with you!'. At the bottom, a small text box provides contact information for a disability accommodation request.

Brady Builds
Friday, February 14th
Location: Brady Desk and seating area
Time: 5:30-7pm

Join us for building valentines, flowers, and enjoy an opportunity to get creative!
Anything you build at the event you can take home with you!

To make a disability accommodation request, please contact the event coordinator, Tamarah Humphreys, at tamarah.humphreys@stthomas.edu at least one week prior to the event.



Event Planning 101

Backwards Scaffolding

One Month Before:

- Brainstorm Ideas/Run them by your CD/GSA

Three Weeks Before:

- Review guidelines and submit TommieLink for approval (including supply and catering requests)

Two Weeks Before:

- Market Your Event (3 unique ways)

One Week Before:

- Make sure you have all supplies, start promoting in GroupMe/via word of mouth

Day Of Event:

- Get there early to set up
- Take a photo during the event
- Clean up & submit Roomcompact Form

Event Planning 101

Budget & Supplies

- **Budgeting**
 - **Check in with your CD/GSA regarding budget for your area**
- **Check the resource room for supplies**
- **We can only utilize in house catering/Summit Marketplace for snacks**
- **Need help brainstorming?**
 - **Communicate with your supervisor in ADVANCE**
 - **1:1s, weekly report, emails, etc.**

Event Planning 101

Resources Available to You

- **RA Resource Room**
 - Supplies, paper, paint, etc.
 - REFRAIN from using create [space]
- **Canva for all your design needs**
- **Online tools:**
 - Pinterest
 - Reslife.net
 - Google search
 - Roompack Blog- [RA360: Program Planning – Roompack](#)
- **Teammates & Fellow RAs for inspiration**

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**Prior
Planning
Prevents
Poor
Performance**
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Set Yourself Up For Success
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Types of Events

- **Individual RA Events** - every individual RA does an event for their small community (for their residents)
- **Paired RA Events** - every RA does an event in a pair (or in a few cases in a group of three on odd numbered RA teams) for their smaller communities (for their residents, however all residents are welcome.)
- **Building/Community Events** - every community does an event for the entire community (can be a small group of RAs planning & executing with support from rest of RA team).
- **RCT Events** – Residential Connection Interns will lead programming for all of campus and we will support this as a department.

DEPARTMENTAL EXPECTATIONS

(First Year Communities)

Fall Semester		Spring Semester	
September	1 Individual RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event	February	1 Individual RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event
October	Homecoming Parade, 1 Paired RA Event (per RA), 1 Building/Community Event	March	1 Building/Community Event
November	1 Building/ Community Event	April	1 Building/Community Event
December	1 Building/ Community Event	May	1 Building/Community Event

* J-Term – no formally required events, we engage via GroupMe 😊*

DEPARTMENTAL EXPECTATIONS

(Second Year Communities)

Fall Semester		Spring Semester	
September	1 Paired RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event	February	1 Paired RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event
October	Homecoming Parade, 1 Building/Community Event	March	1 Building/Community Event
November	1 Building/Community Event	April	1 Building/Community Event
December	None Required	May	None Required

* J-Term – no formally required events, we engage via GroupMe!*

DEPARTMENTAL EXPECTATIONS

(Both Communities)

- Every event needs to be posted on **TommieLink**
 - Attendance is captured at the event via TommieLink
- Complete the Residential Connection Event form on Roompack
 - This form requires a photo from your event.
 - **You will upload the photo into the Roompack form, please be sure it's not an .HEIC file (default in iPhone)**

The background is a solid dark purple. Scattered across the image are several hand-drawn asterisks. Some are white and others are a light orange color. They are positioned around the text, with some appearing in the corners and others closer to the words.

REMEMBER!!!

**CONNECTION is the
PURPOSE!**

MANAGE EVENT

Include your flyer
or a picture for
the event



Let's go to the Mall (of America)



Date and Time

Saturday, September 16 2023 at 1:00 PM CDT to
Saturday, September 16 2023 at 4:30 PM CDT

Add To [Google Calendar](#) | [iCal/Outlook](#)



Location

Mall of America
Bloomington, MN
[View Map](#)

Details of the event
specifics

Login and create
the event under
your specific
community

Description

Join Residence Life for a trip to the Mall of America on Saturday September 16! We will depart from the Flynn Turnaround at 1:15 p.m. via buses and arrive at the Mall of America around 1:30 p.m. You can then shop, explore, head to the food court, or ride some rides! We will then depart from the same point we were dropped off at 4:15 p.m. and return to campus by about 4:30 p.m.

Categories

Free Event

RSVP to Event

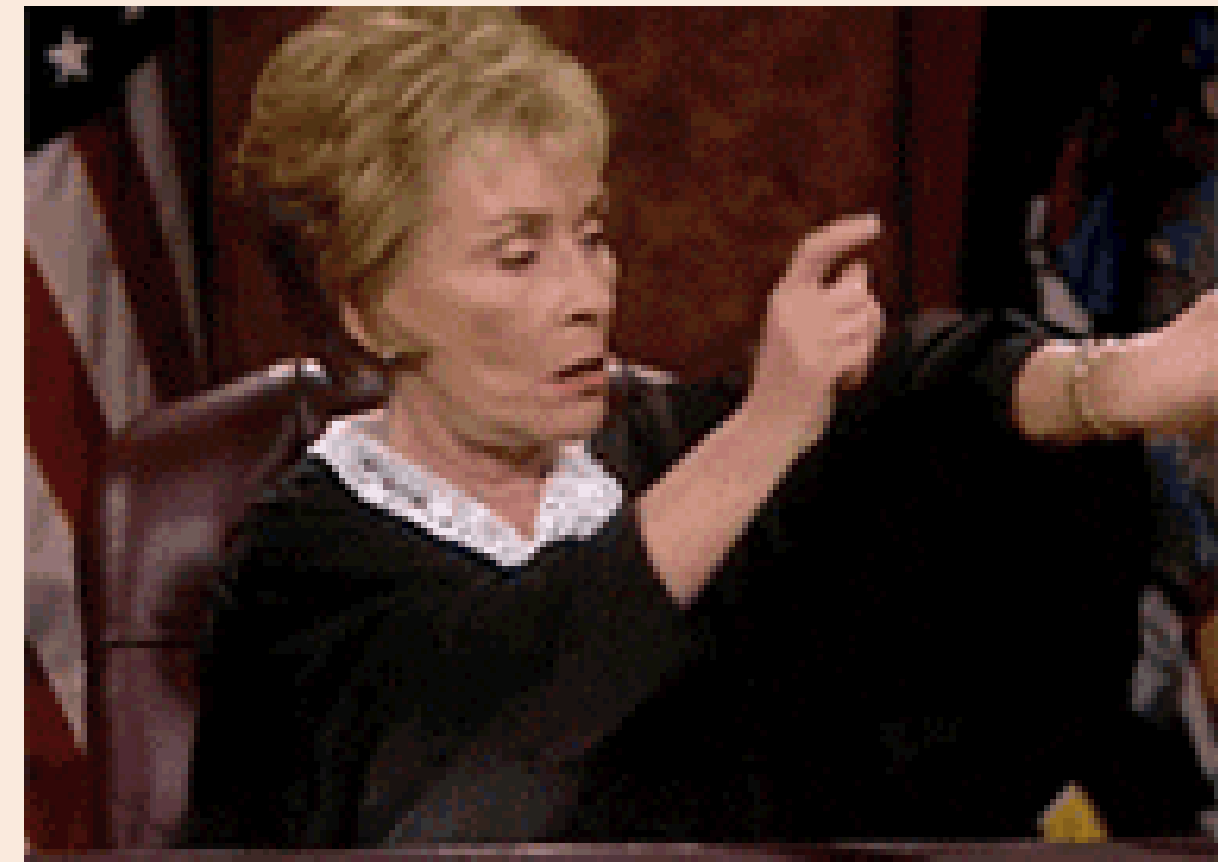
CONTINUE TO RSVP

Provide a
description
of the event

TOMMIE LINK

Finishing Up Your Event

- **Clean up the space** (leave no trace)
- **Bring left over supplies to RA resource room and put away**
 - Leftover Food/Beverages:
 - Offer it to event guests
 - Send a message out in GroupMe
- **Take down any advertising**
- **Submit Roomcompact Form**





Reflect on the experience

- What went well?
- What did you learn?
- How was attendance? Why that level of turnout?
- What should you change for future events?
- What can you celebrate?



Event Planning Worksheet Overview

Residential Connection Event Planning Worksheet

(Departmental Requirements)

First Year Communities

Fall Semester		Spring Semester	
September	1 Individual RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event	February	1 Individual RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event
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December	1 Building/ Community Event	May	1 Building/Community Event

Second Year Communities

Fall Semester		Spring Semester	
September	1 Paired RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event	February	1 Paired RA Event, 1 Building/Community Event
October	Homecoming Parade, 1 Building/Community Event	March	1 Building/Community Event
November	1 Building/Community Event	April	1 Building/Community Event
December	None Required	May	None Required

TommieLink Requirements

- Needs to be submitted at least two calendar weeks before the event.
 - All attendance will be captured utilizing the "Check-In" app on your device.
- You must Include accessibility statement in ALL printed flyers and description on TommieLink, "To make a disability accommodation request, please contact the event coordinator [insert CD/GSA name] at [insert CD/GSA contact information] at least one week prior to the event date."
- The image for event should be a flyer outlining the date, time, location and a brief description of event.
 - When creating your image for TommieLink you will need to set the size to 1300x780 so that the formatting is correct and won't get cut off.
 - This can be done in Canva under "Resize and Magic Switch" in the upper left corner, select resize and set it to 1300x780.

Residential Connection Event Planning Worksheet

Program Title: _____

Team Members Involved: _____

Date(s): _____ Time: _____

Estimated Cost: _____

What kind of program are you planning?

- ☐ Where is your program going to be? _____
 - ☐ Do you need to make a room reservation? Yes/No
 - ☐ If so, when will you inform your CD/GSA? _____

☐ Supplies Needed

- ☐ Did you check the RA Resource room to see if we already have it? Yes/No
- ☐ If we need to buy more supplies, did you submit a request to your CD/GSA for ordering? Yes/No

☐ Catering/Snacks

- ☐ Are you ordering it through catering? If so, it must be ordered in advance. 2 weeks for catered items, 4-5 days for other items. Who will coordinate with your CD/GSA?

- ☐ Buying it at Summit? If so, who is picking it up (ask CD/GSA for Index or preplan order)? _____

How are people going to know about this event?

For Advertising/Posters, be sure to include accessibility statement, "To make a disability accommodation request, please contact the event coordinator [insert CD/GSA name] at [insert CD/GSA contact information] at least one week prior to the event date."

- ☐ Who is making the advertising? _____
- ☐ Where do you want them to go? _____
- ☐ How many copies do you need? _____
 - ☐ Advertising shouldn't just be posters, how else will you advertise for the event?
 - Other advertising ideas _____
 - Who will manage this? _____

How is the program going to be facilitated?

- ☐ Who is setting up the program/taking photos during the event?

- ☐ Who is cleaning up the event?

- ☐ Who is submitting the Roompact Form & uploading the required photo?

Residential Connection Team

About RCT:

- Residential Connection Interns
- Supervised by
 - Ben Clark (Living Learning Programs Manager)
 - Tess Munshower (Residential Connection Coordinator)
- Hosting 5+ Residential Connection Events a month
- Intended for all residential students!!

RCT and You

What we need from you:

- Resident Advisor Support
 - Promote events & encourage participation
 - GroupMe, email, word of mouth, share our TommieLink page
 - Attend events yourself & bring residents with
 - Be mindful of RCT events when planning yours to avoid conflicting event times

Events to Look Forward To

- **Welcome Days**

- [Upcoming Events - Tommie Link](#)

- **September Events**

- **Game Show Night 9/4**
- **Jelly and Jam Trivia Night 9/5**
- **Mill City Farmers Market Trip 9/6**
- **St. Paul Saints Game 9/14**
- **Pancakes and Patches 9/18**
- **Minnesota Zoo Trip 9/20**
- **Slick City Trip 9/28**

[Residential Connection Team Events -
Tommie Link](#)



WHY THIS MATTERS



Belonging & Inclusion

**Residential Connection
Team**

Community Wide Events

Paired RA Events

Critical First Six Weeks

Individual RA Events

**THANK YOU
FOR CREATING EVENTS THAT
FOSTER CONNECTION!**